Giridhar Dhananjay Khaza Venkata

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Sephora — Recruitment Team
Neuilly-sur-Seine

Re: Application for Alternance - Assistant(e) Category Manager MakeUp Europe (F/H/X) (12 months apprenticeship, starting January 2027)

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Alternance - Assistant(e) Category Manager MakeUp Europe (F/H/X) apprenticeship at Sephora in Neuilly-sur-Seine, starting January 2027. I have three years of experience across business development, consulting and analysis, most recently as a Strategy and Marketing Corporate Consultant at FORVIA in Paris, and I am looking for an apprenticeship in product and marketing at a company I can build a career with rather than pass through.

Sephora sits at the point where a brand's intent meets what a customer actually picks up, and its assortment turns over fast enough that the answer keeps moving. That makes it a good place to learn commercial judgement, because you find out quickly whether a call was right. The role itself covers category management for the MakeUp Europe range at Sephora — assortment, supplier coordination across markets and performance tracking for the category — the kind of work where the analysis has to be good enough to act on the same week.

At FORVIA I assess how product lines are positioned and how the markets around them are moving, and I own the group's weekly newsletter, which is a marketing problem as much as an editorial one. At Endosys Technologies I marketed products through conferences, demonstrations and direct meetings, and took customer feedback back into the product itself — one design change I suggested increased sales volumes by 20%. ESSEC's Marketing Management coursework has given me the structure to go with that hands-on experience.

I am currently completing a Master in Management at ESSEC Business School, with coursework in Strategy and Management, Marketing Management, and People and Organizations. Before that I completed a B.Tech in Mechanical Engineering at the National Institute of Technology Calicut (ranked #21 in India, NIRF 2025), covering Operations Research, Project Management, Supply Chain Management, Quality Planning and Analysis, and Management of Production Systems. The engineering degree is where my analytical edge comes from — it taught me to break a problem down to what can actually be measured before arguing about it — and ESSEC has given me the strategic and commercial judgement to put that to work.

I am available from January 2027 and would welcome the chance to discuss how I could contribute to your team. Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,
Giridhar Dhananjay Khaza Venkata